

# Mapping of X

A shrinking social network that is becoming a major player in real-time news.

01 / 16

# Contents

02 / 16

---

## 1 Key dates and news

Twenty years back.

---

## 2 Audience

The world, and France.

---

## 3 Tips and use cases

How to start, and when to stay away.

---

## 4 Leading sectors

The fields where X is still essential.

---

## 5 Accounts to follow

Three highly innovative accounts.

---

## 6 Photo and video quality

The formats that fit the feed.

---

## 7 Management tools

Who does what, and at what price.

---

## 8 Conclusion

Our stance, and an open question.

# Twenty years in ten dates

Jack Dorsey, Biz Stone, Evan Williams and Dick Costolo at the 2013 stock market listing.



2006

Launched on 15 July. First message on 21 March: *just setting up my twttr*.

2007

The **hashtag** is invented by a user, to gather messages on the same topic.

2013

Stock market listing in New York.

2017

The limit moves to **280 characters**.

2022

E. Musk buys Twitter for **\$44bn** and takes it private.

2023

23 July: the bird becomes **X**. The Twitter name is dropped.

2024

17 May: [twitter.com](https://twitter.com) finally redirects to **x.com**.

2025

March: **xAI**, Elon Musk's artificial intelligence company, buys X for \$33bn.

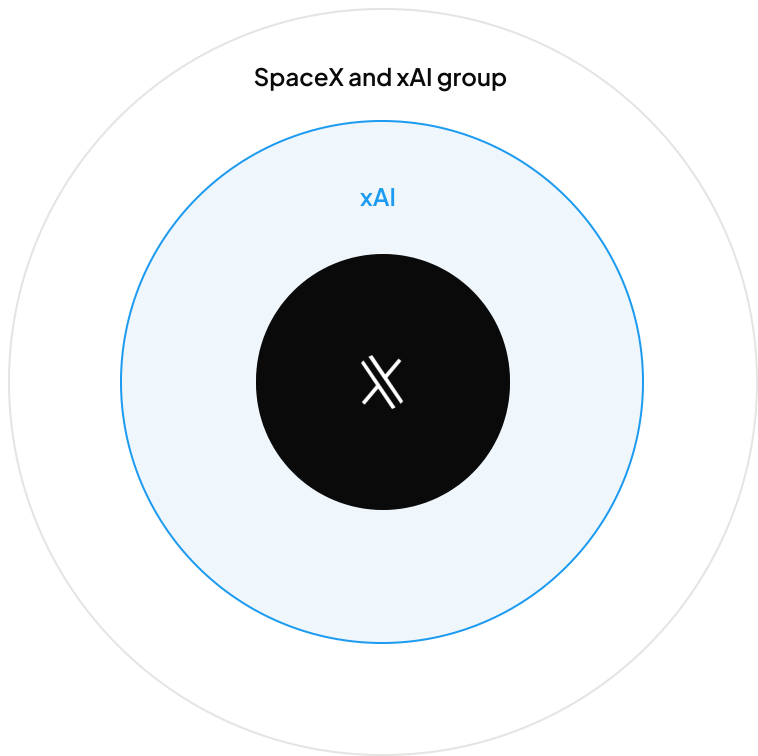
2025

December: **€120m** European fine for breaching the Digital Services Act.

2026

January: the **feed algorithm** is released as **open source**. February: xAI merges with SpaceX.

# Who owns X



- X, the social network, bought by Musk in 2022 for \$44bn.
- xAI, his artificial intelligence company, buys X in March 2025 for \$33bn.
- SpaceX and xAI merge in February 2026. X is no longer the group's main business.

IN FRANCE, THE COMPANY IS STILL CALLED TWITTER

**TWITTER FRANCE SAS**

789 305 596 • Active

Adresse : 25 RUE DU QUATRE SEPTEMBRE, 75002 PARIS

Activité : Conseil en relations publiques et communication

Effectif : Entre 20 et 49 salariés (donnée 2023)

Création : 05/11/2012

Dirigeant : Cheung Kin

Suivre cette entreprise

Voir les statuts

Voir les comptes

Solvabilité

€12.9m

in revenue

20 to 49

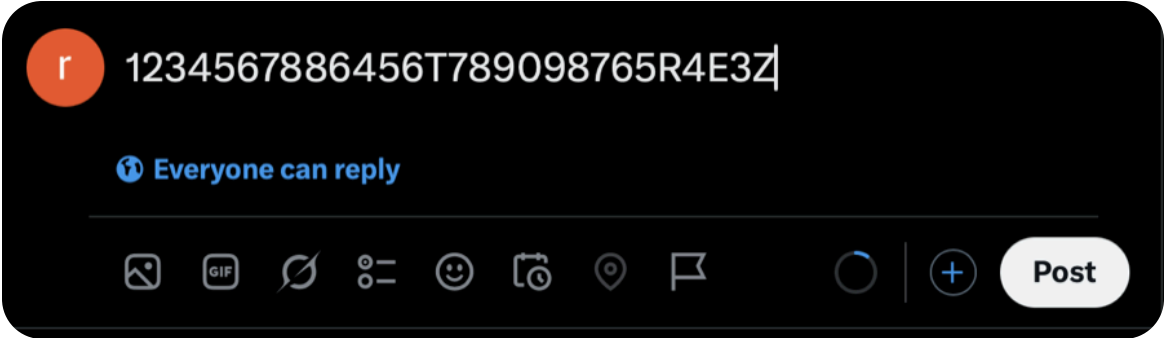
employees

€678k

net profit

X → feeds → Grok

# What X changed about its identity and its product



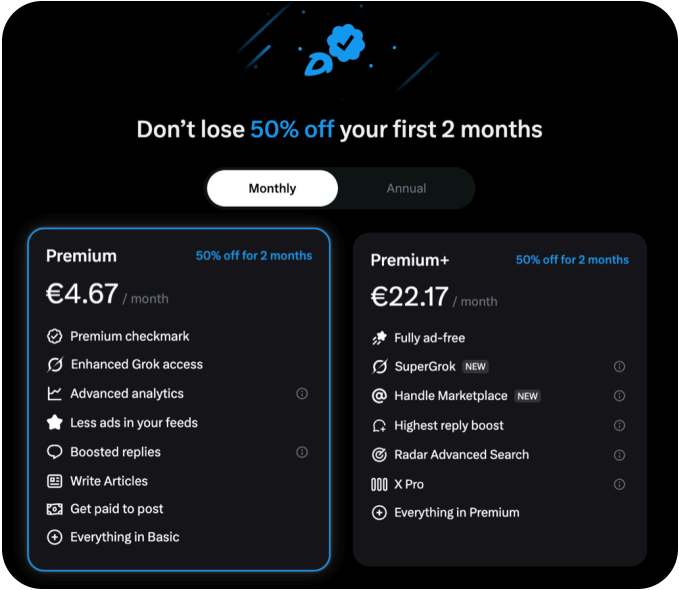
Writing on X. From 140 to 280 characters, plus the indicators.



The hashtag is still how the network sorts itself.



- BIRD: THE CHIRP
- LIGHT, CHATTY, PUBLIC
- X: THE EVERYTHING APP
- NEUTRAL, SERIOUS, EXTENSIBLE
- THE TWEET BECOMES THE POST



- PREMIUM €4.67
- PREMIUM+ €22.17
- BADGE, GROK, NO ADS
- THE BLUE TICK NO LONGER MEANS “VERIFIED”

The tick = subscription ≠ verified identity.  
05/12/25: the European Commission → misleading.

# The global audience, July 2026

4.7bn  
visits per month

5<sup>th</sup>  
website worldwide

12:15  
average duration

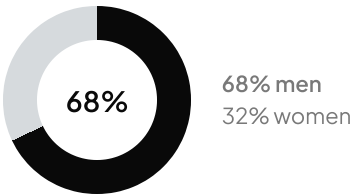
69.8%  
direct traffic

## WHERE THE VISITS COME FROM

|                |       |
|----------------|-------|
| United States  | 29.0% |
| Japan          | 10.9% |
| United Kingdom | 4.5%  |
| Türkiye        | 3.8%  |
| Spain          | 3.6%  |

\* France does not appear in the top five countries.

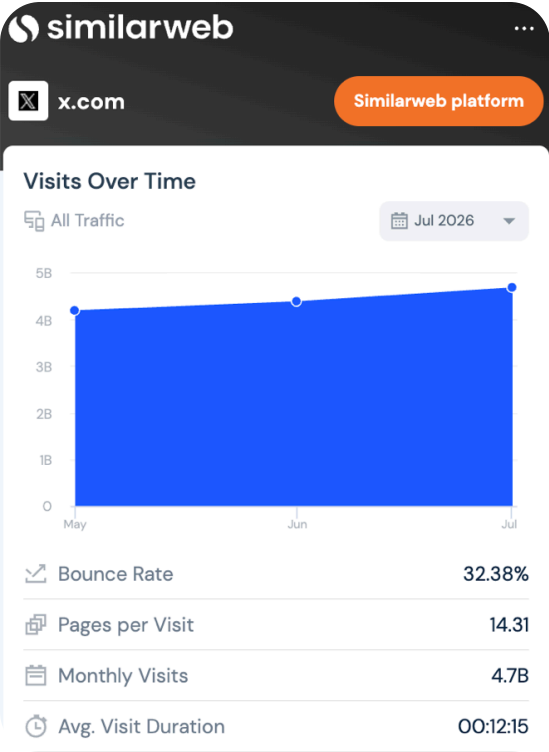
## WHO COMES



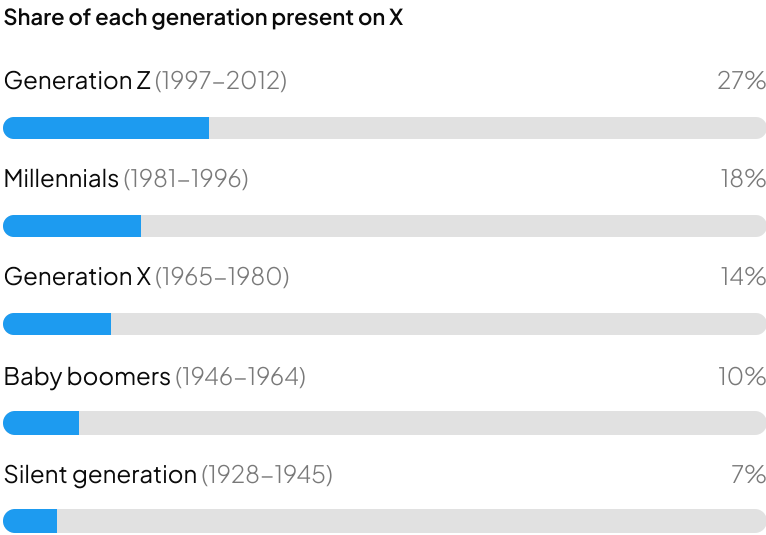
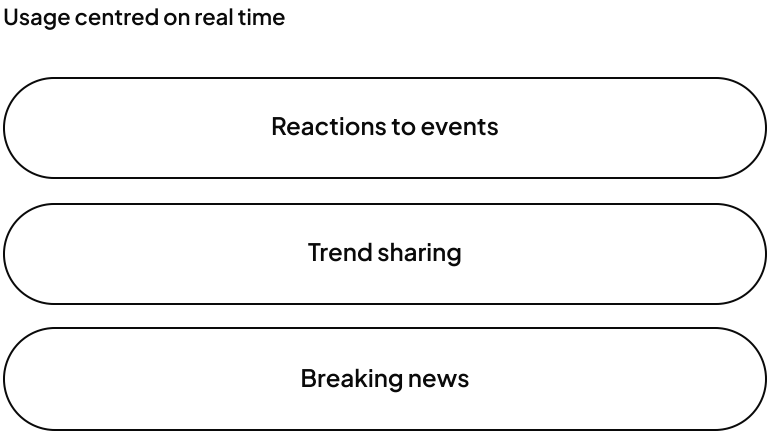
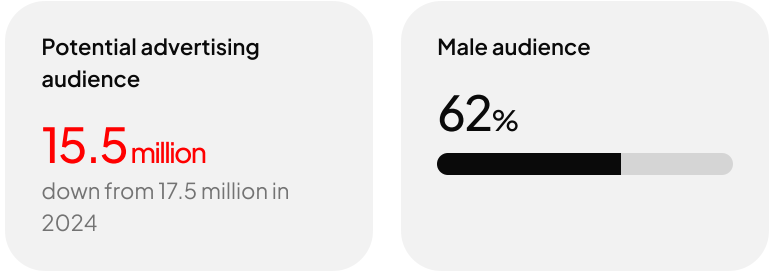
25-34  
the dominant age group

14.3  
pages per visit

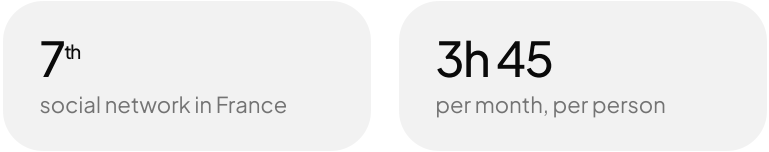
32.4%  
bounce rate, 1/3 of visitors leave



# A drop for France.



Sectors strongly present



Sources: Ecommerce Nation (accessed 06/09/2026), 2024 guide p. 8 and 2025 guide p. 5 · Statista (accessed 06/09/2026), January 2025 and 2024.

# The real user, and the one a brand should target



PERSONA A · THE REAL USER

Théo, 27

Junior developer in Lille

|           |                                |
|-----------|--------------------------------|
| Job       | Junior developer               |
| City      | Lille                          |
| Frequency | 5 to 8 opens a day             |
| Time      | 7 minutes a day, on mobile     |
| Arrival   | Direct, never through a search |

WHAT HE DOES ON X

He reads and does not post. He follows news, tech, football and memes. He bookmarks rather than likes, and filters out advertising in his head.

WHAT DRIVES HIM

Getting informed fast

Being entertained

Taking part, replying

Buying

●●●●●

●●●●●

●●●●●

●●●●●

What he is worth to a brand: visibility, almost no conversion.



PERSONA B · THE BRAND'S TARGET

Camille, 34

Journalist, specialist in her field

|          |                               |
|----------|-------------------------------|
| Job      | Journalist and analyst        |
| City     | Paris                         |
| Audience | 200 to 2,000 followers        |
| Usage    | Daily professional monitoring |
| Reaction | Within the hour, or never     |

WHAT SHE DOES ON X

She posts and quotes. She follows her sources, her competitors and live events, and passes on whatever is useful or funny. One share from her is worth a thousand bought impressions.

WHAT DRIVES HER

Watching her field

Posting and commenting

Building a network

Buying

●●●●●

●●●●●

●●●●●

●●●●●

What she is worth: credibility, and reach at one remove. She is the one we write for.

# The fields where X is still essential

**1 News and politics**  
The reflex during a live event

**3 Sport**  
Second screen during matches

**5 Finance and crypto**  
Real-time market commentary

**2 Tech and artificial intelligence**  
Models are announced here before the press release

**4 Video games and entertainment**  
Release dates and patch notes

**6 Customer service**  
The public complaint, in front of everyone

FEATURES

Thread + Monitoring

Sources: Ecommerce Nation (accessed 06/09/2026), 2024 guide pp. 8–9 and 2025 guide p. 5 · SocialHub Magazine (accessed 06/09/2026), issue 6, 2026.

# Getting started on X: our six recommendations

**01 Post every day, or do not start**

One to three messages a day.

**02 Reply before you post**

Month 1: reply to posts.

**03 Text first, image second**

Virality: image < text.

**04 Originality**

Burger King France follows **no** account and writes like a person.

**05 Follow the event, never the calendar**

One message posted 40 minutes after a match is worth ten scheduled a month ahead.

**06 Measure bookmarks and replies**

A like = polite, a bookmark = useful, a reply = alive.

**WHY THESE TIPS WORK: WHAT THE CODE SAYS**

**48h**

lifespan

Beyond that, the age filter removes the post from the feed.

**2 feeds**

For you and Following

**5**

families of signals

Engagement, clicks, attention, following, negative signals.

Sources: Ecommerce Nation (accessed 06/09/2026), the four objectives on the X page · X (accessed 06/09/2026) · public repository *xai-org/x-algorithm* (accessed 06/09/2026).

# The pros and cons of X

## WORTH DOING

- + **Live events:** matches, conferences, launches, crises.
- + **Public customer service.**
- + **Tech and B2B credibility:** journalists, developers, investors.
- + **Market monitoring.**
- + **Tone:** frank and direct ≠ LinkedIn.
- + **Publishing faster than anywhere else.**
- + **An adult, working audience.**

## TO RULE OUT

- **Falling user base in France:** ↘ 15.5M.
- **Direct selling:** no native store and weak conversion.
- **Women over 45.**
- **A risk-free feed:** fake accounts, crypto scams and automation sit next to the brands.
- **Replacing LinkedIn:** prospecting, recruiting, commercial relationships.

# The most-liked accounts and posts



Elon Musk

@elonmusk

241.5M





Barack Obama

@BarackObama

119.0M





Cristiano Ronaldo

@Cristiano

114.1M





Donald Trump

@realDonaldTrump

111.8M





Narendra Modi

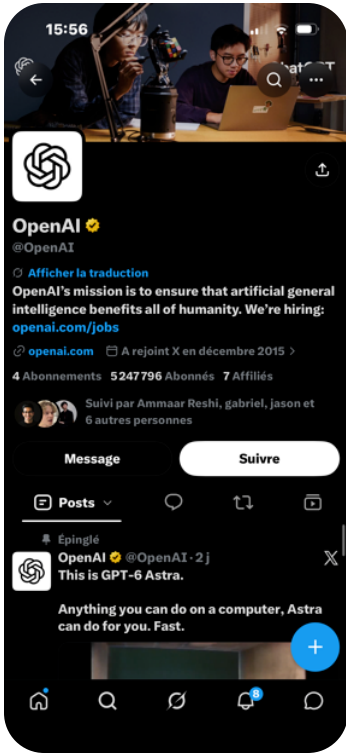
@narendramodi

107.2M



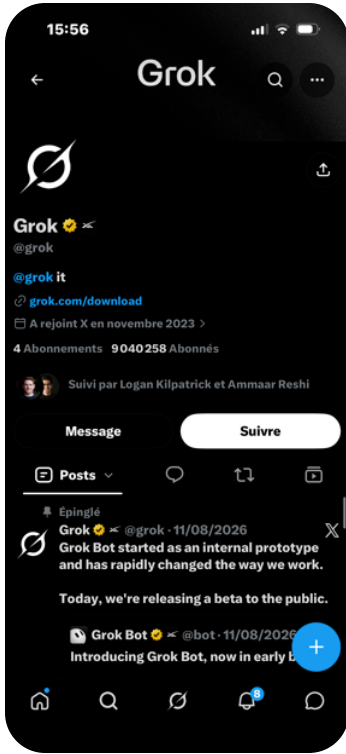
Sources: X (accessed 06/09/2026), screenshots of the profiles and posts taken by Romane and Sofian · Wikipedia (accessed 06/09/2026), lists of most-followed accounts and most-liked posts.

# Three accounts, three inventions



@OpenAI 5.2M followers

- NEWSROOM
- PLAIN-TEXT ANNOUNCEMENT
- NO PRESS RELEASE
- THE LAUNCH IS A POST



@grok 9.0M followers

- NATIVE AI
- REPLIES IN THE FEED
- 39M POSTS
- LIVES IN THE STREAM



@BurgerKingFR 188.7K followers

- FOLLOWS NOBODY
- A PERSON'S TONE
- SAME VOICE SINCE 2013
- DISCIPLINE

Source: X (accessed 06/09/2026).

# The formats that fit the feed

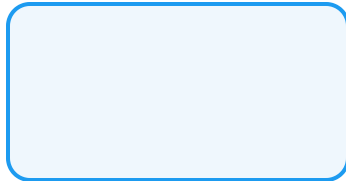
## IMAGES



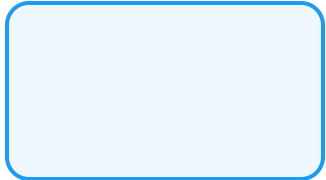
**400 × 400**  
profile picture



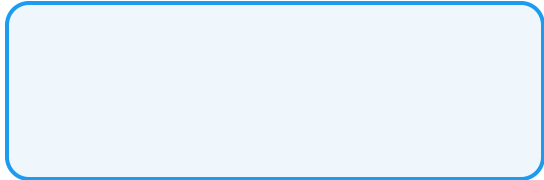
**1200 × 1200**  
square post



**1200 × 628**  
landscape post



**1200 × 675**  
ad · 600 × 335 minimum

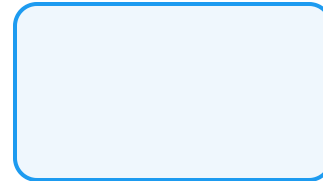


**1500 × 500**  
profile header

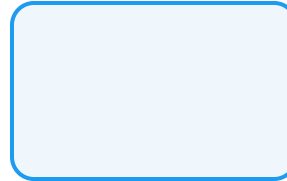
## VIDEO



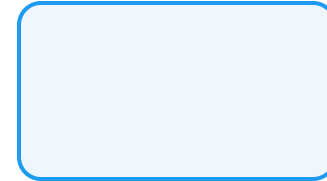
**800 × 800**  
square carousel  
2 to 6 videos



**800 × 450**  
landscape carousel  
2 to 6 videos



**1920 × 1200**  
post · 512 MB  
2 min 20 max



**Ad**  
1:1 or 16:9 · 1 GB  
MP4 or MOV

# Management tools and where they stop

| TOOL                              | WHAT IT IS REALLY FOR                                              | WHERE IT STOPS                                                            |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>X Pro</b> (formerly TweetDeck) | Watching several live columns during an event, like a newsroom.    | Native, now reserved for X Premium subscribers. No real analytics report. |
| <b>X for Business</b>             | Creating and funding advertising campaigns.                        | Advertising only, no community management.                                |
| <b>Buffer</b>                     | Scheduling across several networks, for small teams, at low cost.  | Light analytics, no social listening.                                     |
| <b>Hootsuite</b>                  | Dashboard, multi-account, approval workflow. The agency standard.  | Expensive for a single network.                                           |
| <b>Audiense Connect</b>           | Segmenting the audience and understanding who follows the account. | Specialised in X, paid.                                                   |
| <b>Brandwatch and Mention</b>     | Social listening and alerts in a crisis.                           | Enterprise pricing only.                                                  |

Sources: Ecommerce Nation (accessed 06/09/2026), Tools tab of the 2024 guide and 2025 guide p. 5 · vendors' pricing pages (accessed 06/09/2026).

# Conclusion

# Our sources, and how we actually used AI tools

## Sources

- Ecommerce Nation, *Social Media Guide 2024* pp. 8–9 and 2025 p. 5
- Course deck “class 1 & 2”, slides 51, 52 and 56, and syllabus slides 19 to 21
- SocialHub Magazine issue 6, 2026
- Similarweb, July 2026 data read on x.com
- Pappers, TWITTER FRANCE SAS record, SIREN 789 305 596
- Wikipedia, articles on X, the most-liked posts and the most-followed accounts
- Our own screenshots taken on X

All these sources were accessed on 06/09/2026.

## AI tools, and their limits

-  ChatGPT: content ideas, variety of angles.
-  Claude: online research, source checking, wording, building the presentation.